

Skills Summary

Taking Away and Writing It

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Cross Out to Subtract

Rule: To take away, cross out one object for each one taken. What is left are the objects with *no* cross. Count only those.

Example: 5 stars are drawn. 2 are crossed out. How many stars are left?

Step 1. Crossed-out stars are gone, so we count only the stars without a cross.

Step 2. Counting the plain stars: 1, 2, 3 — and the equation agrees: $5 - 2 = 3$. ✓

$$\Rightarrow 5 - 2 = 3$$

Try it: Draw 6 dots and cross out 4. How many dots are left?

check: 2

Skill 2 — Write the Subtraction Equation

Rule: The story numbers go into the equation in order:
start number — number taken away = number left.

Example: 7 fish are in a tank. 3 are scooped out. Write the equation and solve it.

Step 1. The start number is 7 and the taken-away number is 3, so the equation is $7 - 3$.

Step 2. Count back from 7 three times: 6, 5, 4. ✓

$$\Rightarrow 7 - 3 = 4$$

Try it: 8 bees are on a flower. 5 fly off. Write the equation and solve it.

check: 3

Skill 3 — Take-Away Facts with Ten

Rule: Taking a number from 10 leaves its **partner**: think “what goes with it to make 10?” instead of counting back.

Example: $10 - 8$

Step 1. Instead of counting back 8 times, we ask which partner goes with 8 to make ten.

Step 2. $8 + 2 = 10$, so taking 8 away leaves 2. ✓

$$\Rightarrow 10 - 8 = 2$$

Try it: $10 - 3$ (think: 3 and what make ten?)

check: 7

(!) Watch out: Count what is *left*, not what you crossed out! In a picture of $6 - 2$, the answer is the 4 plain objects — not the 2 with crosses.
